Other Suns, 'they did what human beings looking for freedom, throughout history, have often done. They left.'[25] Over six decades, nearly six million black Southerners, mostly from rural areas, left their lands and spread out across the wide expanse of America, settling mainly in urban centres. In India, on the other hand, Gandhian prescriptions against city life hold importance in certain policy circles such that rural to urban migration is still considered to be a 'problem' that needs to be checked.[26] But despite Gandhi's love for the village, it should be remembered that even he was sympathetic to the question of caste and migration as he noted that:[27]

> If Harijans are physically ill-treated in a place and if they cannot get redress in any other way, they should leave that village and we should encourage them to do so . . . what is the harm if the Harijans, all or some of them, leave the place after serving notice on the caste Hindus?

Brain Drain

Britain, and to a lesser extent the United States of America, began attracting Indian students for higher studies from the late 19th century. Almost all the stalwarts of the Indian freedom movement pursued higher studies abroad and returned to India to work. In 1888, in one of his first recorded speeches as a teenager about to depart for higher studies in England, Gandhi told his friends, 'I hope that some of you will follow in my footsteps, and after you return from England you will work wholeheartedly for big reforms in India.'[28] By 1946, on the eve of Independence, his view on foreign education was slightly different. Asked if independent India should continue sending people abroad for studies, he replied:[29]

> No, not just now. I would advise her to send them there only after, say, 40 years . . . I repeat that they should go there only after they have reached maturity. Because, it is only when they have learnt to understand the good that is in their own culture that they will be able to truly appreciate and assimilate the best that England or America has to give them. Imagine a boy of seventeen, like myself, going to England—he will simply be submerged.